

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in a newspaper in Hong Kong:

9-year-old's America's Got Talent appearance sparks parenting debate

The appearance of nine-year-old Hong Kong singer Celine Tam on US talent show *America's Got Talent* has reignited a debate on parenting, with some members of the public accusing her parents of not letting her have a childhood.

Other bloggers have defended her parents, however, claiming that her parents are only helping Celine achieve her dreams.

Tam's audition – in which she sang the hit *My Heart Will Go On* – went viral with over 7 million views. Local media reported that she began learning to sing when she was three years old. She practises for several hours a day, and has participated in numerous televised Hong Kong and mainland Chinese talent shows in her nine short years.

But Tam's story sparked comments from some Hongkongers. "This is outrageous," wrote one commenter on the Facebook page of news outlet Apple Daily. "Just another way for her parents to make money off her."

Another agreed: "Why couldn't they have waited until she's older and more mature before pushing her out in front of everyone?"

Others disagreed, however, claiming that Tam's experience was not extraordinary. "Many children have entered similar competitions. As a parent, if you don't make a decision for your kids, people will say you're irresponsible," wrote ManInCentral-CK. "But if you make a decision for them, people will say you don't respect their wishes."

TVB has asked your school if any of the students would like to take part in a new talent show. Your music teacher has asked you for your opinions on talent shows. You may want to talk about:

- why talent shows are popular
- the advantages and disadvantages of taking part in talent shows
- whether parents should let their children take part in talent shows
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you watch talent shows?
2. Would you like to be on a talent show?
3. Should schools organise talent shows for students?
4. What could children learn from competing in a talent show?
5. What advice would you give to a young child entering a talent show?
6. Do you think talent shows will remain popular in the future?
7. What would be stressful about being on a talent show?
8. Why do people want to be famous?